

AUSTIN PUBLIC SCHOOLS  
OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDENT  
AUSTIN 1, TEXAS

April 9, 1959

Dr. George I. Sanchez, Chairman  
Department of History and Philosophy of Education  
The University of Texas  
Austin, Texas

Dear Dr. Sanchez:

Thank you very much for your letter asking for information about the curricular plans for the new Riverside High School. Mr. Hernandez called me about this matter a week or two ago, consequently, I am very glad to explain it to you so that you can pass the word along.

Riverside High School will be a comprehensive high school like the William B. Travis, Stephen F. Austin and McCallum high schools. I imagine that the rumor started about the disproportionate amount of emphasis being given to the vocational work by the fact that we have enlarged the vocational rooms to accommodate trade groups from the city. The different trades of plumbing, electricity, auto mechanics and carpentry are donating special equipment for the use of adults in the Evening School. Of course, this is profitable to us for use by our own regular trade and vocational classes. However, no plans have been made to over-emphasize the vocational more than to offer opportunity for anyone who wishes to take these trades. Anticipating a demand, we may put in a class in cosmetology and vocational nursing. This would be in the homemaking department. We look on this as a constructive measure that we wish we had provided in all of our high schools. All of this will be elective and unless the classes materialize out of interest of the students they will not be given.

To sum up my statements, I repeat, Riverside High School will be a comprehensive high school with all of the offerings that we offer in the other high schools. Of course, such subjects as foreign language will depend on the interest of the students, as will any other class that is not required. The same amount of mathematics, English, science, foreign language and other subjects will be in the curriculum and there is no difference in philosophy and concept of this program than you find elsewhere.

I would appreciate your passing this information along to counteract the idea that Riverside High School will be "different."

With kindest regards, I am

Sincerely yours,

  
Irby B. Carruth

IBC:cr